MAURYAN, BUDDHIST, JAIN AND ROCK-CUT HERITAGE

MAURYAN ART CLASSIFICATION → ASHOKAN PILLAR SYSTEM → BARABAR EVIDENCE CARD → STUPA ANATOMY → SANCHI ACCRETION → CHAITYA VERSUS VIHARA

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

MAURYAN ART CLASSIFICATION

MAURYAN ART CLASSIFICATION · PILLARS AND PALACE ARCHITECTURE · YAKSHA, TERRACOTTA AND DONORS · ROYAL AJIVIKA CAVE DEDICATIONS · USEFUL CATEGORIES, POROUS BOUNDARY · MUST REMEMBER · THE MAURYAN-TO-ROCK-CUT SEQUENCE DISTINGUISHES ASHOKAN PILLARS AND · BARABAR-NAGARJUNI AJIVIKA CAVES, STUPA ACCRETION AT SANCHI, CHAITYA-VIHARA FUNCTIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COURT → pillars and palace architecture	VERDICT → useful categories, porous boundary	phases, Ellora's plural complex and later Jain and Shaiva sites.
NON-COURTLY → yaksha, terracotta and donors	MUST REMEMBER: The Mauryan-to-rock-cut sequence distinguishes Ashokan pillars and	
CROSSOVER → royal Ajivika cave dedications	Barabar-Nagarjuni Ajivika caves, stupa accretion at Sanchi, chaitya-vihara functions, Ajanta	

CORE CLAIM
- COURT → pillars and palace architecture
- NON-COURTLY → yaksha, terracotta and donors
- CROSSOVER → royal Ajivika cave dedications

MECHANISM
- VERDICT → useful categories, porous boundary
- MUST REMEMBER: The Mauryan-to-rock-cut sequence distinguishes Ashokan pillars and
- Barabar-Nagarjuni Ajivika caves, stupa accretion at Sanchi, chaitya-vihara functions, Ajanta

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- phases, Ellora's plural complex and later Jain and Shaiva sites.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Barabar-Nagarjuni Ajivika caves, stupa accretion at Sanchi, chaitya-vihara functions, Ajanta phases, Ellora's plural complex and later Jain and Shaiva sites.

01

STAGE 01

ASHOKAN PILLAR SYSTEM

ASHOKAN PILLAR SYSTEM · CHUNAR SANDSTONE · MONOLITHIC SHAFT · IMPERIAL FINISH · LION, BULL OR OTHER ANIMAL FORMS · MESSAGE VARIES BY SITE

CHUNAR SANDSTONE → monolithic shaft → POLISH → imperial finish → CAPITAL → lion, bull or other animal forms → INSCRIPTION → message varies by site

CORE CLAIM
- CHUNAR SANDSTONE → monolithic shaft
- POLISH → imperial finish

MECHANISM
- CAPITAL → lion, bull or other animal forms
- INSCRIPTION → message varies by site

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CHUNAR SANDSTONE → monolithic shaft
- POLISH → imperial finish

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAPITAL → lion, bull or other animal forms.

02

STAGE 02

BARABAR EVIDENCE CARD

BARABAR EVIDENCE CARD · JEHANABAD DISTRICT, BIHAR · THIRD CENTURY BCE · ASHOKA AND DASHARATHA · AJIVIKAS, NOT BUDDHISTS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PLACE → Jehanabad district, Bihar	PATRONS → Ashoka and Dasharatha	PLACE → Jehanabad district, Bihar
DATE → third century BCE	SECT → Ajivikas, not Buddhists	DATE → third century BCE

CORE CLAIM
- PLACE → Jehanabad district, Bihar
- DATE → third century BCE

MECHANISM
- PATRONS → Ashoka and Dasharatha
- SECT → Ajivikas, not Buddhists

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PLACE → Jehanabad district, Bihar
- DATE → third century BCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PATRONS → Ashoka and Dasharatha; SECT → Ajivikas, not Buddhists.

03

STAGE 03

STUPA ANATOMY

STUPA ANATOMY · RELIC MOUND · VEDIKA + PATH · BOUNDARY AND MOVEMENT · HARMIKA + CHATTRA · SUMMIT AND HONOUR · NARRATIVE GATEWAY

ANDA → relic mound → VEDIKA + PATH → boundary and movement → HARMIKA + CHATTRA → summit and honour → TORANA → narrative gateway

CORE CLAIM
- ANDA → relic mound
- VEDIKA + PATH → boundary and movement

MECHANISM
- HARMIKA + CHATTRA → summit and honour
- TORANA → narrative gateway

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ANDA → relic mound
- VEDIKA + PATH → boundary and movement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HARMIKA + CHATTRA → summit and honour; TORANA → narrative gateway.

04

STAGE 04

SANCHI ACCRETION

SANCHI ACCRETION · BRICK CORE AND PILLAR · ENLARGEMENT AND STONE FACING · SATAVAHANA PERIOD · CARVED TORANAS · SHRINES AND LATER ADDITIONS

MAURYAN → brick core and pillar → SUNGA → enlargement and stone facing → SATAVAHANA PERIOD → carved toranas → GUPTA → shrines and later additions

CORE CLAIM
- MAURYAN → brick core and pillar
- SUNGA → enlargement and stone facing

MECHANISM
- SATAVAHANA PERIOD → carved toranas
- GUPTA → shrines and later additions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MAURYAN → brick core and pillar
- SUNGA → enlargement and stone facing

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SATAVAHANA PERIOD → carved toranas; GUPTA → shrines and later additions.

05

STAGE 05

CHAITYA VERSUS VIHARA

CHAITYA VERSUS VIHARA · PRAYER AND ASSEMBLY · CHAITYA PLAN · APSE, COLUMNS AND STUPA · MONASTIC RESIDENCE · FUNCTION EXPLAINS FORM

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CHAITYA → prayer and assembly	VIHARA → monastic residence	CHAITYA → prayer and assembly
CHAITYA PLAN → apse, columns and stupa	RULE → function explains form	CHAITYA PLAN → apse, columns and stupa

CORE CLAIM
- CHAITYA → prayer and assembly
- CHAITYA PLAN → apse, columns and stupa

MECHANISM
- VIHARA → monastic residence
- RULE → function explains form

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CHAITYA → prayer and assembly
- CHAITYA PLAN → apse, columns and stupa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VIHARA → monastic residence; RULE → function explains form.

06

STAGE 06

AJANTA IDENTIFIER

AJANTA IDENTIFIER · WAGHORA RIVER · HORSESHOE GORGE · ROCK-CUT SETTING · EARLY PHASE · LATER PHASE · VAKATAKA FLORESCENCE

WAGHORA RIVER → horseshoe gorge

SAHYADRI → rock-cut setting · EARLY PHASE → Satavahana-linked → LATER PHASE → Vakataka florescence

CORE CLAIM
- WAGHORA RIVER → horseshoe gorge
- SAHYADRI → rock-cut setting

MECHANISM
- EARLY PHASE → Satavahana-linked
- LATER PHASE → Vakataka florescence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WAGHORA RIVER → horseshoe gorge
- SAHYADRI → rock-cut setting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EARLY PHASE → Satavahana-linked; LATER PHASE → Vakataka florescence.

07

STAGE 07

ELLORA SHARED HILLSIDE

ELLORA SHARED HILLSIDE · MONASTERIES AND WORSHIP HALLS · KAILASHA AMONG MAJOR WORKS · DIGAMBARA CAVE GROUP · BROAD SEQUENCE WITH OVERLAP

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BUDDHIST → monasteries and worship halls	JAIN → Digambara cave group	BUDDHIST → monasteries and worship halls
BRAHMANICAL → Kailasha among major works	CHRONOLOGY → broad sequence with overlap	BRAHMANICAL → Kailasha among major works

CORE CLAIM
- BUDDHIST → monasteries and worship halls
- BRAHMANICAL → Kailasha among major works

MECHANISM
- JAIN → Digambara cave group
- CHRONOLOGY → broad sequence with overlap

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BUDDHIST → monasteries and worship halls
- BRAHMANICAL → Kailasha among major works

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: JAIN → Digambara cave group; CHRONOLOGY → broad sequence with overlap.

08

STAGE 08

INSCRIPTION EVIDENCE TEST

INSCRIPTION EVIDENCE TEST · NAMES PATRON OR CLAIM · MONUMENT AND LANGUAGE · GRANT, EDICT OR EULOGY · OMISSION LIMITS NEUTRALITY

TEXT → names patron or claim

CONTEXT → monument and language · GENRE → grant, edict or eulogy → SILENCE → omission limits neutrality

CORE CLAIM
- TEXT → names patron or claim
- CONTEXT → monument and language

MECHANISM
- GENRE → grant, edict or eulogy
- SILENCE → omission limits neutrality

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TEXT → names patron or claim
- CONTEXT → monument and language

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GENRE → grant, edict or eulogy; SILENCE → omission limits neutrality.

09

STAGE 09

JAIN ARCHITECTURE SCALES

JAIN ARCHITECTURE SCALES · UDAYAGIRI-KHANDAGIRI AND ELLORA · DILWARA, RANAKPUR AND KHAJURAHO · SHRAVANABELAGOLA RITUAL FOCUS · PALITANA AND SHIKHARJI · CLOSE DISTINCTION · A CHAITYA IS A PRAYER OR ASSEMBLY HALL AND

CAVE → Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora

TEMPLE → Dilwara, Ranakpur and Khajuraho · COLOSSUS → Shravanabelagola ritual focus → LANDSCAPE → Palitana and Shikharji

CORE CLAIM
- CAVE → Udayagiri-Khandagiri and Ellora
- TEMPLE → Dilwara, Ranakpur and Khajuraho

MECHANISM
- COLOSSUS → Shravanabelagola ritual focus
- LANDSCAPE → Palitana and Shikharji

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall and a vihara is a residence
- a stupa has relic-votive functions and pre-Buddhist antecedents, while Sanchi's Ashokan core, later enlargement, gateways and additions are

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: A chaitya is a prayer or assembly hall and a vihara is a residence; a stupa has relic-votive functions and pre-Buddhist antecedents, while Sanchi's Ashokan core, later enlargement, gateways and additions are separate layers.

10

STAGE 10

IMAGE-PROGRAMME TRANSITION

IMAGE-PROGRAMME TRANSITION · BUDDHA REPRESENTED BY SYMBOLS · NARRATIVE AND ANICONIC PROGRAMME · ANTHROPOMORPHIC BUDDHA IMAGES · FIGURAL IMAGE JOINS SACRED FOCUS · EVIDENCE LIMIT · HATHIGUMPHA AND DONOR INSCRIPTIONS IDENTIFY CLAIMS AND PATRONS BUT

EARLY → Buddha represented by symbols → STUPA → narrative and aniconic programme → LATER → anthropomorphic Buddha images → SHRINE → figural image joins sacred focus → EVIDENCE LIMIT: Hathigumpha and donor inscriptions identify claims and patrons but are selective records

CORE CLAIM
- EARLY → Buddha represented by symbols
- STUPA → narrative and aniconic programme

MECHANISM
- LATER → anthropomorphic Buddha images
- SHRINE → figural image joins sacred focus

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Hathigumpha and donor inscriptions identify claims and patrons but are selective records
- Elephanta attribution remains debated and Ellora's Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain phases overlap.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Hathigumpha and donor inscriptions identify claims and patrons but are selective records; Elephanta attribution remains debated and Ellora's Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain phases overlap.

11

STAGE 11

ROCK-CUT ANSWER SPINE

ROCK-CUT ANSWER SPINE · EXCAVATED, DURABLE ARCHITECTURE · PLAN, PATRON, INSCRIPTION AND STYLE · BARABAR, AJANTA AND ELLORA · DURABLE PATRONAGE IS NOT ALL SOCIAL LIFE

DEFINE → excavated, durable architecture → EVIDENCE → plan, patron, inscription and style → COMPARE → Barabar, Ajanta and Ellora → QUALIFY → durable patronage is not all social life

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE → excavated, durable architecture
- EVIDENCE → plan, patron, inscription and style

MECHANISM
- COMPARE → Barabar, Ajanta and Ellora
- QUALIFY → durable patronage is not all social life

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEFINE → excavated, durable architecture
- EVIDENCE → plan, patron, inscription and style

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → durable patronage is not all social life.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ASI'S CONSERVATION MANDATE EXPLICITLY COVERS SCULPTURES AND PAINTINGS · TREATING ELLORA'S TRI-RELIGIOUS CHARACTER AS EVIDENCE OF SIMULTANEOUS · TREATING THE COURT/POPULAR BINARY AS A LITERAL FUNDING MAP. · CITING THE HATHIGUMPHA INSCRIPTION AS A COMPLETE, NEUTRAL HISTORICAL · ASSUMING MAURYAN POLISH REMAINED A NORMAL GUPTA TECHNIQUE · PHILOSOPHY OWNS THE DOCTRINAL CONTENT OF BUDDHISM, JAINISM AND · ANCIENT HISTORY OWNS FULL DYNASTIC POLITICAL NARRATIVE (MAURYAN

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- ASI's conservation mandate explicitly covers sculptures and paintings
- NOT: Treating Ellora's tri-religious character as evidence of simultaneous,
- NOT: Treating the court/popular binary as a literal funding map.
- NOT: Citing the Hathigumpha inscription as a complete, neutral historical

ADVANCED DEBATE
- NOT: Assuming Mauryan polish remained a normal Gupta technique. - Its
- NOT: Philosophy owns the doctrinal content of Buddhism, Jainism and the
- NOT: Ancient History owns full dynastic political narrative (Mauryan
- This file's layered-patronage method is directly reusable for topic

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 00 Master-Framework.md Section 4 — the evidence hierarchy (direct
- CAUTION: Downstream topics: Topic 03 applies the same layered-patronage
- Verified against Nitin — pdf , PDF pp. 40–69 directly, including the
- CAUTION: Open caution: precise dynastic attribution for some individual

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels